lips to her cheek, and kissed her.

The carriage **jolted** forward, and she drew her hand away.

'Goodbye, mother!' said Satish, as the train began to move slowly out of the station. Satish and his mother waved to each other.

'Good-bye,' I said to the other woman, Goodbye — mother ...'

I didn't wave or shout, but sat still in front of the window, gazing at the woman on the platform. Satish's mother was talking to her, but she didn't appear to be listening; she was looking at me, as the train took me away. She stood there on the busy platform, a pale sweet woman in white, and I watched her until she was lost in the milling crowd.



About the Author



Ruskin Bond is a short story writer, novelist and poet, the favourite writer of Indian children. His first novel, **Room on the Roof,** was published when he was still in his teens. This novel won him the John Rhys Memorial Award in 1957. He also writes about children and the simple hill folk of Uttarakhand. Simplicity and fluency of language and an insight into human nature are hallmarks of his style. His major writings include **An Island of Trees, A Bond with the Mountains** and **The India I Love.** He has also been honoured with the Sahitya Akademi Award for his contribution to Indian literature.

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